NEWS ON AIR: SPOTLIGHT

*A Special Radio Report on BRICS Traditional and **Indigenous** Sports*

Chapter 1: Introduction to BRICS sports

This is Akashwani in the program spotlight. Now we bring you a special radio report on strengthening traditional and **indigenous** sports and cultural practices amongst BRICS countries. This program is being presented by Anubha Rohki and produced by Miknabos. Today's program explores how BRICS countries are working to strengthen traditional and **indigenous** sports and cultural practices. Sports are more than competitions. They carry the stories, traditions and cultural identities of communities across generations. From malikham and kaler piat in India to capoiraa in Brazil, woou in China and sambu in Russia, traditional and **indigenous** sports reflect the **diversity** of human civilization. At a time when international sporting events often focus on records, rankings, and medals, traditional sports offer a different **perspective**. They bring communities together, preserve cultural heritage, and create opportunities for countries to learn from one another. With this objective, India has brought together BRICS nations to strengthen **collaboration** in traditional and **indigenous** sports, promote cultural exchange and encourage people-to-people connections.

Chapter 2: Inaugurating the games

The BRICS traditional and **indigenous** sports **demonstration** games 2026 are being held today 12th October at the Vir Sawar Sports Complex in Ahmedabad under India's BRICS chair. The Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports is organizing the one-day event in **collaboration** with the government of Gujarat. The Union Minister for Youth Affairs and Sports Dr. Mansukandria inaugurated the games. The event has brought together India and 10 other participating BRICS nations, Belarus, Bolivia, Brazil, China, Ethiopia, Iran, Kazakhstan, Russia, South Africa and United Arab Emirates to demonstrate traditional sporting practices and share cultural knowledge. Designed as a non-competitive platform, the games focus on **demonstration** and the exchange of traditional sporting practices. The emphasis is not on winning medals but on understanding the traditions, techniques and values behind each sport. India's BRICS chairship theme building for **resilience**, **innovation**, cooperation and **sustainability** provides a framework for cooperation across several sectors including sports and cultural exchange.

Chapter 3: Showcasing diverse traditions

The range of sports on display highlights the **diversity** of traditions across participating countries. India is showcasing malam yogasa and kalar pay. Brazil is demonstrating capoiraa along with the **indigenous** blowpipe game Zarabatana, the log race Kurida de Toras and Brazilian para jiujitsu. China is presenting woou lion dance and health kong while Russia is showcasing and gurotki.

South Africa has brought kagati and lintonga to the event. Other participating delegations are also demonstrating their distinctive sporting and cultural traditions. These include Belarus's Gorotki, Bolivia's Luca de Kolitas, Tinku Raya Trompo, Kachinas and Krera de Sakos, Ethiopia's Tele Wrestling, Jenna and traditional board games, Iran's Zur Khan, Haftang and Ghane, Kazakhstan's Aeku, Toggis Kulmalak and Khazak Kuresi and the United Arab Emirates Al Taba. Each of these practices has its own history and **significance**. Together they illustrate how sport can serve as a living expression of cultural identity. For BRICS countries, the initiative offers an opportunity to develop a deeper understanding of one another's heritage. It also creates space for practitioners, trainers and cultural representatives to interact directly, exchange techniques and explore ways to keep traditional sports relevant for younger generations.

Chapter 4: Vision for sporting excellence

India has placed traditional and **indigenous** sports at the center of its efforts to promote cultural exchange and cooperation under the BRICS framework. Let us now hear Union Minister for Youth Affairs and Sports Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya on the importance of traditional sports and opportunities they offer for greater cooperation among BRICS nations. "India's **indigenous** sports offer the global community a unique **blueprint** for the future of athletic abilities blending ancient heritage with modern high performance. This tradition of excellence is showcased by Malcolm. A display of an aerial gymnastic on a wooden pole mastery of human biomatics is equally on display in coloru one of the world's oldest martial art. We have already demonstrated the immense international scalability of chest through kabadi." Dr. Mandia has said that India is placing sport at the center of nation building by investing in future ready sports infrastructure. He described a **comprehensive** 360 degree approach that includes grassroots participation, talent identification, coaching, sports science, infrastructure development, athlete welfare and international exposure.

Chapter 5: Heritage and Holistic Wellness

He also highlighted an allocation of $3.76 billion US for the Khelo India initiative aimed at upgrading sports infrastructure across the country and training young athletes. According to the minister, India's ambition is not only to build world-class sporting infrastructure for today but also to create a lasting sporting legacy for generations to come. India's traditional sporting heritage reflects a long-standing relationship between physical discipline, mental well-being, and cultural knowledge. Malikam combines strength, balance, and **agility** through movements performed on a wooden pole or rope.

Dr. Mandia described it as a form of aerial gymnastics that demonstrates exceptional physical control while requiring minimal infrastructure. Kalar pay one of the world's oldest martial arts incorporates physical conditioning, coordinated movement and martial techniques. Yoga brings together posture, balance, flexibility and controlled breathing. Kabati demonstrates how a traditional sport can grow from rural mud courts into an organized commercially broadcast discipline without losing its cultural essence. It is also a medal sport at the Asian Games. Dr. Mandia has said that India's traditional values of vasudhaiva kutumbakam physical discipline and **holistic** well-being align with the Olympic values of excellence, respect and friendship. Yoga in particular has gained international recognition as a practice associated with physical and mental well-being. Its emphasis on balance, breathing, and **mindfulness** has created opportunities for cultural exchange and dialogue on health across countries. The larger challenge, however, is to ensure that these practices remain **accessible**, are documented responsibly and continue to be passed on to future generations.

Chapter 6: Ground report from Ahmedabad

The BRICS traditional and **indigenous** sports **demonstration** games 2026 are bringing together diverse sporting traditions at the Vir Sawaker Sports Complex in Ahmedabad. Today marked a proud and historic moment for sports **diplomacy** as Ahmedabad welcomed delegations from across the globe for the celebration of shared heritage. Addressing the gathering, Union Minister Dr. Mansuk Mandavia emphasized that India is actively building a sustainable sports **ecosystem** for the future. Designed deliberately as a non-competitive platform, these games focused heavily on **demonstration**, documentation, and exchange of unique sporting traditions emphasizing cultural **significance**, practitioners interaction, and deep knowledge sharing rather than medals. Ultimately, these games are serving as a unique bridge for celebrating rich sporting identities while fostering deep mutual understanding, cultural exchange, and **enduring** people-to-people ties across the countries.

Chapter 7: Inclusivity in sports

One of the important considerations in strengthening traditional sports is ensuring that participation is not limited by gender, physical ability, geography, or economic circumstances. Creating greater opportunities for women and girls to participate, train, and represent their communities can help widen the reach of these sporting traditions. Similarly, para athletes and persons with disabilities must have opportunities to participate wherever suitable adaptations can be made.

Efforts to make sports more **accessible** to women, parathletes, and people from underserved communities, can help broaden participation, and make sporting activities more inclusive. India's approach focuses on creating opportunities for all while ensuring that sport remains a means of **empowerment** and social inclusion. Let us hear from the Union Minister: "We are equally committed to ensuring that sports is inclusive, **accessible** and representative of all through dedicated initiatives for women athlete, par athletes and underserved communities." India is working to create equal opportunities across the sporting **ecosystem**.

Chapter 8: Future cooperation framework

Beyond showcasing traditional sports, the focus is also on preserving this heritage for future generations. India has proposed that BRICS nations create a **repository** of traditional and **indigenous** sports documenting their history, rules, equipment and field of play requirements. "We should work towards creating a voluntary bricks **repository** of traditional and **indigenous** sports documenting their history, cultural **significance**... Second, we should encourage exchange among participations and partnership in coaches, teachers, educational institutions and cultural expert across bricks countries." At the same time, documentation must respect the communities that preserve these practices and **acknowledge** the contribution of traditional knowledge holders. In the longer term, cooperation through documentation, practitioner exchanges, and periodic demonstrations could help traditional sports gain greater visibility and encourage their continued practice among younger generations. The larger message is clear. Preserving traditional sports is not only about **safeguarding** the past. It is also about creating a more inclusive future in which cultural heritage, physical well-being, and international cooperation go hand in hand.